



INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT RANCHI

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (MBA)

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-27

CORE

COURSE NAME: MACRO ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

TERM: II

CREDITS: 3

FACULTY DETAILS

Name of the Faculty	Faculty Office Address	Email
Sudhanshu Shekhar (2 Section)	BM Block - 609	sudhanshu.shekhar@iimranchi.ac.in
Aditya Agarwal (1 Section)	SK Block- 304	aditya.agrawal@iimranchi.ac.in
Prabhu (1 Section)	SK Block - 702	prabhu@iimranchi.ac.in
Rameshwar Ture (1 Section)	SK Block - 306	rameshwar.ture@iimranchi.ac.in

CONSULTATION TIME FOR STUDENTS

Name of the Faculty	Timing
Sudhanshu Shekhar	With prior appointment
Aditya Agarwal	With prior appointment
Prabhu	With prior appointment
Rameshwar Ture	With prior appointment

COURSE DESCRIPTION

The management of complex organizations requires a thorough understanding of the impact of organization design on organization effectiveness. Therefore, the course is designed to introduce participants to various aspects of structuring, designing and bringing change and development in organizations. The course discusses relevance of various structural forms and linkages to design and transformation of organizations by understanding their relationship with contingencies such as organizational strategy, environment, culture, technology, firm growth stage, internal politics and conflict. The course also endeavors to bring in appreciation of further aspects of design and restructuring by building on learning the contingencies mentioned above with specifics of change management.

COURSE OBJECTIVE

This course focuses on the fundamentals of organization design and structure, and the contingencies governing design choices.

CLO-PLT-ASSESSMENT TOOL MAPPING:

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	Program Level Trait (PLT)	Assessment Tool(s)
1. To be able to diagnose macro-organizational issues	1.1 Students should be able to diagnose complex business problems	End Term
2. To be able to propose solution to macro-organizational issues	1.2 Students should be able to prescribe recommendations to complex business problems	End Term
3. To be able to assess the interconnectedness of different business functions and its impact on macro organizational issues	4.1 Students should be able to identify interconnectedness across business functions	End Term
4. To be able analyze the advantages and disadvantages of different types of organizational structure		Quiz
5. To understand the relationship between organizational structure and contingencies		Quiz

PRESCRIBED TEXTBOOK:

Textbook: Richard L. Daft and Nishant Uppal (2020). *Understanding the Theory and Design of Organizations 11th ed.* Cengage Learning.

EVALUATION SCHEME:

Evaluation Components as per Program Manual Rules	Details	Weightage
Working with AI Assignment	Students have to work on an assignment that uses AI tools	25%
End Term Exam	The questions would be based on the analysis and application of concepts	40%
Attendance	Marks will be awarded as per attendance evaluation rule	10%
Class Participation	Marks awarded based on participation in class activities and discussions	10%
Quiz	Multiple choice questions – 1 Quiz	15%
Total		100%

INDIVIDUAL ASSIGNMENT DETAILS: Students have to work on an assignment related to the course that uses AI tools.

GROUP ASSIGNMENT DETAILS: None

SOFTWARE(S) USED (Yes/No) (If yes, please provide details): **No**

FIELD TRIPS / WORKSHOPS PLANNED (Yes/No) (If yes, please provide details): **No**

ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT: Please refer latest program manual (MBA/MBA-BA/MBA-HRM/IPM/MBA-Executive) provided to you.

ELEMENTS OF SOCIAL IMPACT IN COURSE CURRICULUM (YES/NO) (If yes, please mention session details/case details/other reading material details which has implications to social impact): **None**

RUBRIC FOR CLASS PARTICIPATION:

Part I: Class Discipline & Engagement (40% / 40 Points)

Criteria	Exceptional	Competent	Needs Improvement	Unsatisfactory
Punctuality & Presence (15 pts)	Always on time; present for all sessions; rarely leaves the room during lectures. (15 pts)	Arrives on time consistently; no unexcused absences. (12 pts)	Occasionally late; 1–2 unexcused absences or frequent room exits. (6 pts)	Frequently tardy; multiple unexcused absences. (0 pts)
Professional Conduct & Preparation (15 pts)	Brings required readings/case materials; actively listens to peers; shows respect for diverse perspectives. (15 pts)	Brings materials; attentive listener; maintains a respectful baseline attitude. (12 pts)	Unprepared (missing cases/readings); occasionally distracted or disengaged during peer contributions. (6 pts)	Disruptive; disrespectful to instructor or peers; clearly unprepared. (0 pts)
Digital Hygiene (10 pts)	Devices used exclusively for class work; zero non-academic distractions. (10 pts)	Devices generally used appropriately; minimal non-class distraction. (8 pts)	Visible distraction from phones/laptops during class discussions. (4 pts)	Continuous off-task digital activity; ignores warnings regarding device use. (0 pts)

Part II: Meaningful Class Participation (60% / 60 Points)

Criteria	Exceptional	Competent	Needs Improvement	Unsatisfactory
Quality of Insight & Conceptual Rigor (25 pts)	Offers well-reasoned arguments grounded in course frameworks, case facts, and business logic; advances the discussion. (25 pts)	Offers relevant observations based on reading; connects concepts to the topic with basic accuracy. (20 pts)	Remarks are surface-level, purely opinion-based, or repeat points already made by others. (10 pts)	Contribution demonstrates a lack of reading or understanding of core concepts. (0 pts)
Frequency & Consistency (20 pts)	Consistently contributes across sessions without dominating or monopolizing airtime. (20 pts)	Participates regularly (at least once per session/discussion unit). (15 pts)	Participates rarely or only when cold-called; long stretches of silence across sessions. (7 pts)	Never volunteers; relies entirely on cold-calling or remains silent throughout term. (0 pts)
Synthesis & Peer	Builds directly on peers' comments	Listens and acknowledges	Makes isolated comments that	Intercepts or dominates

Engagement (15 pts)	("connects the dots"); asks probing questions that deepen class debate. (15 pts)	others' contributions before stating own point. (10 pts)	ignore the flow of the current conversation. (5 pts)	conversations; ignores peer contributions entirely. (0 pts)
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DETAILED SESSION PLAN

Session No.	Business Problem	Topic(s) and Discussion Questions	Readings (Text Book, Articles, Cases)	Pre-Read
1	How do we choose and design an appropriate organizational structure?	Introduction to Organizations What is an organization? What are the different types of organizations?	Chapter 1, pg 2 - 45	
2	How should organizations divide and coordinate their work?	Introduction to Organizations Why do organizations exist? What is the process of organizing?	Chapter 1, pg 2 - 45	
3	How can managers measure organizational effectiveness?	Organizational Effectiveness What is organizational effectiveness? Why is organizational effectiveness important?	Chapter 3, pg 119-141	
4	How to identify and choose an appropriate effectiveness framework?	Organizational Effectiveness What are the different models for measuring organizational effectiveness?	Case 1a: Moore, A., & Toefy, T. (2025). Measuring CSR: A Menu of Options (8707-HTM-ENG) Case 1b: Pailwar, V.K. (2020). Sterlite Copper: Profit Versus Public Health, Ivey (W20989-PDF-ENG)	
5	How to design a formal structure for organizations?	Organizational Design: Formal Structure What is horizontal and vertical differentiation? What are the different types of organizational structure?	Chapter 2, pg 50-74	
6	What are the advantages and disadvantages of different organizational structures?	Organizational Design: Formal Structure (Continued) What are the pros and cons of vertical and horizontal differentiation? What are the advantages and disadvantages of each organizational structure?	Chapter 2, pg 77-94 Case 2a: Renseas Restructuring (Provided by Faculty) Case 2b: Mukherjee, S. (2020). Mahindra Financial Services: Restructuring for Growth (IMB813-PDF-ENG)	
7	What are the dynamics of	Organizational Design: Informal Structure	Case 3a: Thomas, N. (2025). The Hidden Org	Reading 1: Leonardi, P. &

	informal structure in organizations?	What are different types of informal structure in organizations? How does informal structure impact organizational effectiveness?	Chart: Redesigning Roles at LSV, HBS (8844-HTM-ENG)	Contractor, N. (2018). Better People Analytics. <i>HBR</i>, 70-81 Reading 2: Krackhardt, D., & Hanson, J. (1993). Informal Networks: The Company Behind the Chart. <i>HBR</i>, 105-111 Reading 3: Vohra, N., & Thomas, N. (2016). Investigating Organizational Learning through Social Network Analysis: The case of a Consultancy Firm in India. <i>Thunderbird International Business Review</i>, 58(6), 588-600
8	How to analyze informal relations in organizations?	Organizational Design: Informal Structure (Continued) How do informal structures emerge in organizations? How do we analyze informal structures in organizations?	Problem Set: Informal Network in Organizations (Provided by Faculty) Case 3b: Cross, R., Halliday, A.L., Gulas, V., Parker, A., & Vigneux, T.. (2009). Building a Networked Organization: Restructuring the IT department at MWH (A), HBS (UV1096-PDF-ENG)	
9	What is the impact of organizational environment?	Environment and Structure What is organizational environment? What are different types of organizational environment?	Chapter. 6, pg. 220-258	
10	How does organizational environment impact organizational structure?	Environment and Structure (Continued) How can organizations respond to changes in the organizational environment?	Chapter. 6, pg. 220-258 Case 4a: Crisis at Nestle (Provided by Faculty) Case 4b: Gandhi, V., Kalk, R., & Dey, K. (2024). Tata Power and India's Energy Transition, HBS (325081-PDF-ENG)	
11	What are the different elements of organizational	Strategy and Structure What is organizational strategy? What are different types of	Chapter. 3 (pg. 100-117)	

	strategy?	organizational strategies?		
12	How does strategy affect organizational structure and vice-versa?	Strategy and Structure (Continued) How does organizational strategy affect organizational structure and vice-versa?	Chapter. 3 (pg. 100-117) Case 5a: Dabur acquires Basdhah (Provided by Faculty) Case 5b: Pai, V.S. (2021). Reliance Jio: Leveraging Late Mover Advantage, Ivey (9B21M038)	
13	What are different stages in organizational life cycle?	Organizational Size & Life Cycle What is organizational life cycle? What is organizational size?	Chapter. 12, pg. 468-507	
14	How does organizational size and life cycle impact organizational structure?	Organizational Size & Life Cycle (Continued) What type of organizational structure is suitable for different life cycle stages of organizations? What type of structure is suitable for different organizational sizes?	Chapter. 12, pg. 468-507 Case 5a: Sun Microsystems – Managing Hypergrowth (Provided by Faculty) Case 5b: Srinivasan, S., Arora, N., & Goldberg, J.S. (2019). Dabur India: Growing Professional Management from Family Roots, HBS (119089-PDF-ENG)	
15	How do organizations identify an appropriate technology?	Organizational Technology What is a technology? Why is technology important for organizations?	Chapter. 13, pg. 508-547 Reading 4: Fountaine, T., McCarthy, B., & Saleh, T. (2019). Building the AI-powered Organization. <i>HBR</i> , 63-73	
16	How does organizational technology affect organizational workflows and structure?	Organizational Technology How does technology impact task workflow in organizations? How technology and organizational structure impact each other?	Chapter. 13, pg. 508-547 Case 6a: Crime Anticipation System at Dutch Police (Provided by Faculty) Case 6b: Palepu, K., Das, N., & Kak, R. (2023). Digital Transformation at Tata Steel, HBS (323-053)	
17	How does organizational culture impact organizational effectiveness?	Organizational Culture What is organizational culture? Why is culture important for organizations?	Chapter. 9, pg. 344-381	
18	How to design an appropriate culture in organizations?	Organizational Culture How is organizational culture formed? What are different types of	Chapter. 9, pg. 344-381 Case 7a: Cultural Integration – Post Merger Challenges (Provided by	

		organizational culture?	Faculty) Case 7b: Bajaj, H., & Mitragotri, R. (2022). Ultratech and Jaypee Merger: Integrating Culture and People, Ivey (W26218-PDF-ENG)	
19	How to envision and plan for change?	<i>Managing Organizational Change</i> What is the antecedent and consequence of change in organizations? What are different types of organizational change?	Guest Session 1	
20	How to manage and execute change?	<i>Managing Organizational Change</i> How can organizations navigate change? How to handle conflicts during change?	Guest Session 2	

Working with AI Assignment

Evidence-Based Organizational Change Diagnosis and Theoretical Model Building

Course	Macro Organizational Behavior
Assessment	Individual AI-Assisted Mid-Term Project
Marks	25
Academic Year	2026-27

1. Student Assignment Brief

Step 1: Select an Organization and Define the Change Problem [2 marks]

Select one organization for which credible information for the most recent five-year period is reasonably available. Each student must select a unique organization. Submit the organization name, five-year period, industry and context, focal organizational change, and one central research question. Identify one coherent change process rather than narrating every development in the organization.

Step 2: Develop an Evidence Base [4 marks]

Collect and organize evidence from annual reports, investor presentations, regulatory filings, official announcements, credible newspapers and business press, reputed industry publications, interviews where feasible, and other trustworthy sources. Submit an evidence log. A recommended minimum is 5 credible sources, including at least two organization-generated primary sources and two independent external sources, distributed across the five-year period. AI-generated summaries, snippets, or answers are not evidence. Every factual claim must be traceable to an identifiable source.

Step 3: Generate Alternative Explanations Using AI [4 marks]

Use an approved AI tool to generate at least two alternative explanations of the focal organizational change. Provide the research question, selected evidence, relevant course concepts, and explicit instructions to distinguish evidence from inference, identify contradictions, and locate missing evidence. Submit complete prompts, follow-up prompts, screenshots or exported transcripts, tool name/version where available, date of interaction, and labelled provisional models.

Step 4: Critically Evaluate the AI Output [6 marks]

Distinguish supported, plausible-but-unsupported, inaccurate, and fabricated claims. Identify generic concepts, missing contingencies, superficial use of theory, level-of-analysis problems, and failures to explain mechanisms. Also, identify overlapping constructs, ambiguous definitions, unsupported causal arrows, absent feedback loops, weak boundary conditions, and temporal inconsistencies. Compare rival explanations and state what additional evidence would support one versus the other.

Step 5: Conduct Qualitative Analysis based on Gioia Framework [3 marks]

Prepare a compact data structure containing first-order concepts, second-order themes, and

aggregate dimensions. Explain how evidence was coded, combined into themes, and used to form final constructs. Every AI-suggested code or theme must be reviewed against the underlying evidence. Students remain responsible for all final coding decisions. Refer to the research paper below for details on the Gioia framework.

Gioia, D. A., Corley, K. G., & Hamilton, A. L. (2012). Seeking Qualitative Rigor in Inductive Research: Notes on the Gioia Methodology. *Organizational Research Methods*, 16(1), 15–31.

Step 6: Develop the Final Original Theoretical Model [4 marks]

Construct one original visual model explaining the focal organizational change and building upon, extending, qualifying, combining, or challenging ideas from existing change models. Refer to Stouten et al. (2018) for a summary of the existing organizational change models. Where relevant, include triggers, contingencies, managerial interpretations, mechanisms, temporal stages, intended and unintended outcomes, feedback loops, and boundary conditions. Originality may arise from a new construct, mechanism, integration, sequence, feedback loop, boundary condition, contextual qualification, or explanation of an anomaly. Every construct and arrow must be explained in the student's own words.

Stouten, J., Rousseau, D. M., & Cremer, D. De. (2018). Successful organizational change: Integrating the Management Practice and Scholarly Literatures. *Academy of Management Annals*, 12(2), 752–788.

Step 7: Reflection and AI-Use Disclosure [2 marks]

Write a 400–500-word reflection on what AI did well, where it was generic or inaccurate, how prompt shaped output, what human judgment was necessary, and how the final model differs from AI-generated versions. Disclose accepted, modified, and rejected AI suggestions.

2. Required Analytical Templates

2.1 Evidence Log

Evidence ID	Date	Event / observation	Source	Factual extract	Initial theoretical relevance
E01					
E02					

2.2 Data Structure based on Gioia Framework

First-order concepts	Second-order themes	Aggregate dimensions
Evidence-near codes		

2.3 Claim Verification Table

AI-generated proposition	Supporting evidence ID	Status	Student decision
Exact factual claim		Supported / partly supported / unsupported / contradicted	Retain / revise / reject
Proposed relationship		Strong / plausible / weak	Reasoned decision
Suggested construct		Distinct / overlapping / generic	Final treatment

3. Required Submission Structure

Part A: Main Analytical Submission

1. Title page
2. Organization and focal change
3. Research question
4. Five-year change timeline
5. Evidence-based organizational diagnosis
6. Gioia-inspired data structure
7. Critical evaluation of AI-generated explanations
8. Final theoretical model
9. Explanation of the final model
10. Method and AI-use disclosure
11. Reflection
12. References

Part B: AI Audit Appendix

1. AI tool details
2. Complete initial prompt and AI response
3. Follow-up prompts and responses
4. Screenshots or transcript
5. Claim-verification table
6. Rejected AI suggestions
7. Declaration of authorship and AI use

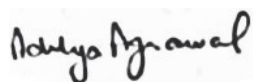
4. Recommended word allocation

Component	Suggested length
Organizational context and focal change	300 words
Critical evaluation of AI output	700-800 words
Explanation of final theoretical model	2,000 words
Method, including Gioia analysis and AI-use details	1,000 words
Reflection on AI use	400-500 words
References and appendices	Not included in word count

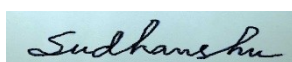
Approximate assessed narrative: 4,400-4,600 words.

5. Detailed Evaluation Rubric: 25 Marks

Criterion	Marks	Excellent	Competent	Developing	Weak
Organization selection and problem formulation	2	Precise, significant, well-bounded change and research question	Clear but somewhat broad	Mainly descriptive or weakly bounded	No coherent focal change or question
Evidence base and five-year timeline	4	Credible, diverse, traceable and well-distributed evidence; timeline reveals patterns	Reliable evidence with minor gaps	Limited diversity or weak traceability	Sparse, unreliable, or AI-generated material used as evidence
AI prompting and documentation	4	Iterative, context-rich prompts generate rivals, test assumptions, and reveal gaps; complete audit trail	Relevant and documented, with limited iteration	Generic prompting or incomplete documentation	AI output without meaningful prompt design or disclosure
Critical evaluation of AI output	6	Systematically identifies unsupported claims, genericity, overlap, omissions, weak causality, and alternatives using course concepts	Identifies major strengths and weaknesses with reasonable theory	Mostly descriptive commentary	Accepts AI uncritically or offers unsupported opinions
Gioia-inspired analysis	3	Clear evidence-to-concept-to-theme-to-dimension logic; transparent human coding	Coherent structure with minor gaps	Categories weakly connected to evidence	No defensible data structure
Final original theoretical model	4	Clear, parsimonious, evidence-based and original; mechanisms, sequence, outcomes, and boundaries are defensible	Coherent with some original adaptation	Mostly relabels an existing framework or AI output	Decorative or unsupported model
Reflection and AI-use disclosure	2	Candid, specific; clearly distinguishes AI contribution and human reasoning	Adequate reflection and disclosure	Generic or incomplete	Absent or misleading disclosure
Total	25				



(A. Agrawal)



(Sudhanshu Shekhar)



(Prabhu)